SHORT · DELTA LAKE

What is Delta Lake?

Delta Lake stores table data as Parquet files and adds a transaction log that records every change.

Key points

- Transactions: a write finishes completely, or not at all.
- Schema rules protect columns from bad data.
- Time travel reads an older version of the same table.
- DESCRIBE HISTORY lists versions. VERSION AS OF reads an earlier one.

Tiny example

Use the earlier version number from history. The Short does not fix that number.

```
DESCRIBE HISTORY schema.table_name;

SELECT *
FROM schema.table_name
VERSION AS OF <earlier_version>
```

Misconception check

A folder of Parquet files is not, by itself, a Delta table. Parquet stores the data. The transaction log makes the table trustworthy.

Remember

Parquet stores the data. Delta Lake makes the table trustworthy.

The Short says DESCRIBE HISTORY and VERSION AS OF work on a free account. This sheet does not add other Delta features to that claim.